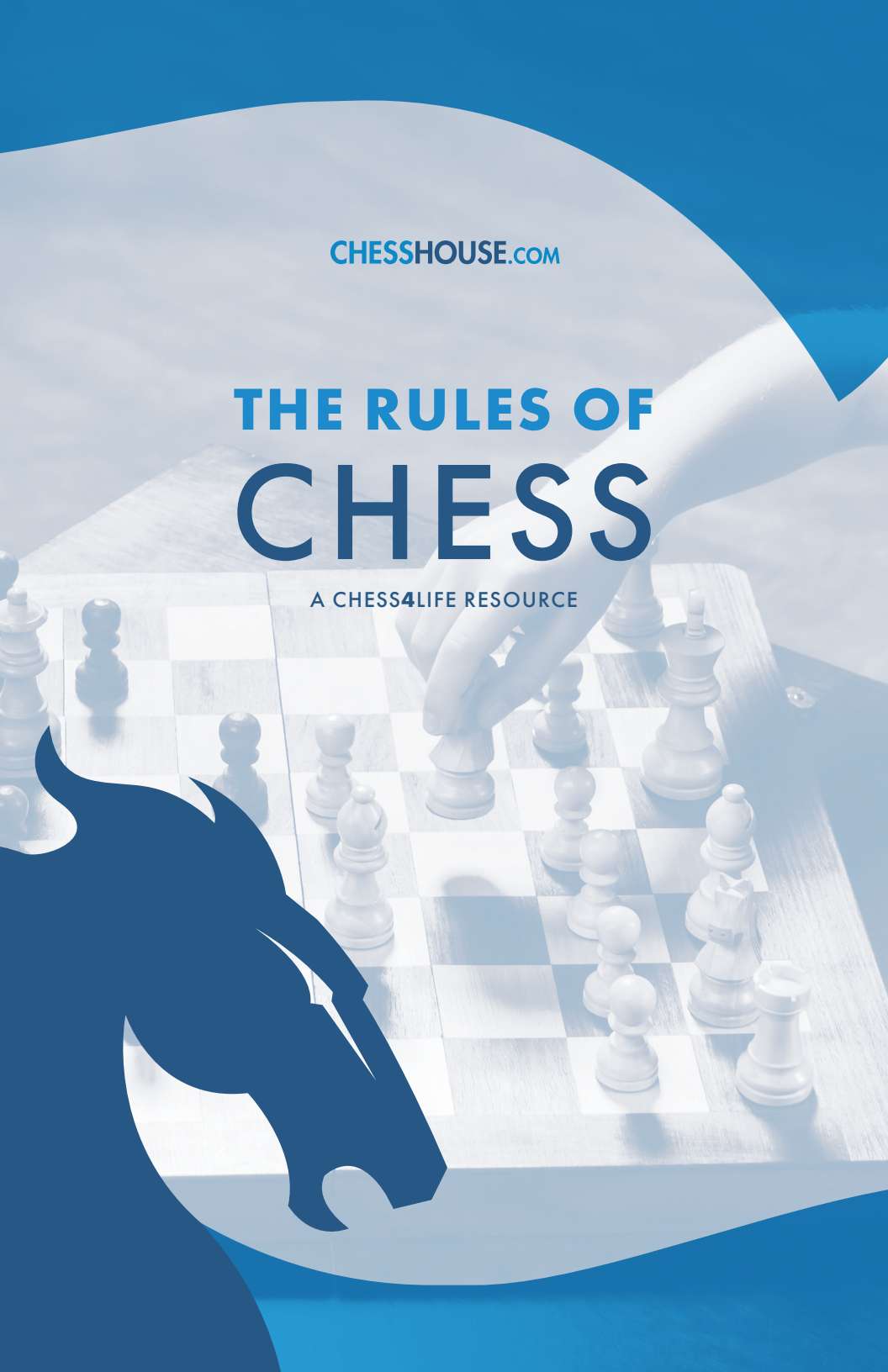


CHESSHOUSE.COM

THE RULES OF CHESS

A CHESS4LIFE RESOURCE



TOPIC 1

THE GAME



Chess is a game for **two players**. One player controls the white pieces and the other player controls the black pieces. Traditionally, players start the game by shaking hands with their opponent. **White always moves first** and then players take turns (white then black then white, etc). Turns consist of moving a piece from one square to another square (as described in

topics 4 - 9). A player may capture an opponent's piece by moving their piece to the square the opponent's piece occupies, in doing so, removing the opponent's piece and setting it on the side of the board. *A player may never capture their own piece. The goal of the game is to checkmate an opponent's King (as explained in Topic 11).*

Pop Quiz

- 1 How many players participate in a game of chess? _____
- 2 Which color moves first? _____
- 3 How many moves do you get to make each turn? _____
- 4 May you capture your own pieces? _____

THE BOARD

The chess board is a checkered board made up of eight vertical columns, called **files**, and eight horizontal rows, called **ranks**. This creates **64 squares**, both **light** and **dark**. Every rank and file has a name. The **a - file**, **b - file**, **c - file**, etc. The **1st rank**, **2nd rank**, etc. This gives every square a name listed by letter and number (eg. b3, d7, g5, h1) Ref: [Figure 2.1]. The chessboard must be set up so that both players have a white square on their right hand corner.

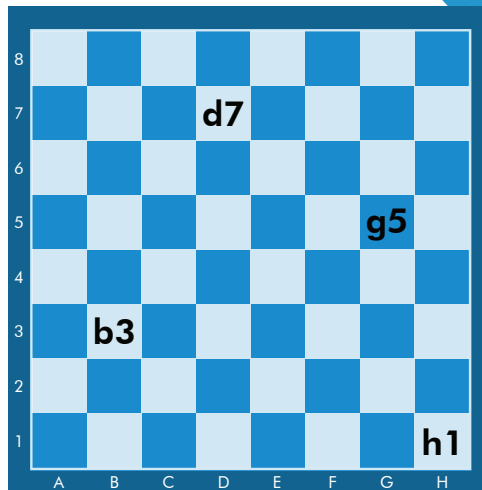


Figure 2.1

Fun Activity

Know the Board: Gently drop a Knight onto the chess board and name the square it lands on. Every correct answer gets you 1 point!

Play with a friend or family member and see who can name the square first... play to 10 points.

TOPIC 3

THE PIECES

There are **six** different types of chess pieces: **King, Queen, Rook, Bishop, Knight, and Pawn**. The chess set contains pieces of two different colors, one light and one dark, called **White** and **Black**. The board is set up as shown [Ref: Figure 3.1]. The white pieces begin on the **1st** and **2nd** ranks and the black pieces begin on the **7th** and **8th** ranks. The white Queen begins on a light square and the black queen begins on a dark square.

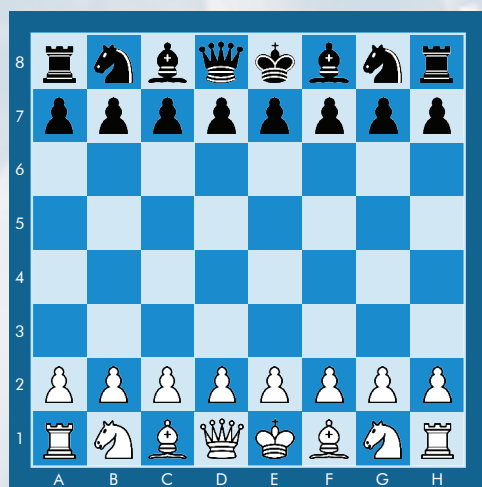


Figure 3.1

Each piece has a relative point value **based on its mobility**. Understanding these point values allows a player to evaluate whether exchanging pieces is a good or bad idea; however, point values have **no direct impact** on the result of a game. See *topic 11* for how to win a chess game.

Fun Activity

Ready, SETUP, Go! The Chess4Life team was able to setup the board in less than 14 seconds. Can you beat this time?

THE KING

Since the object of the game is to checkmate the **King**, it is the most important piece in the game of chess. The King moves **one square** in any direction. The King captures in the same way that it moves (moving the King one square to the square that the opponent's pieces occupies and then removing the opponent's piece) [Ref: Figures 4.1 & 4.2]. The King may **never move into or through danger** and the King may **never be removed from the board**. If a player makes a move that leaves or puts their King in danger, this is an **illegal move**. It must be taken back and a legal move must be played. The white King begins the game on **e1** and the black King begins the game on **e8**.

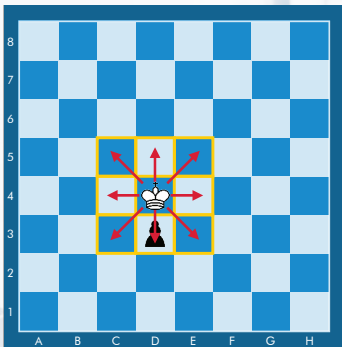


Figure 4.1

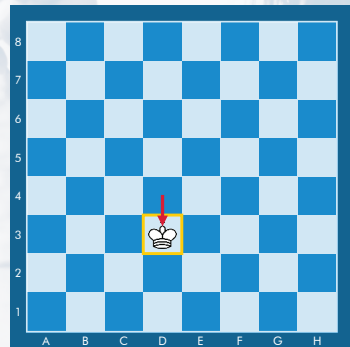
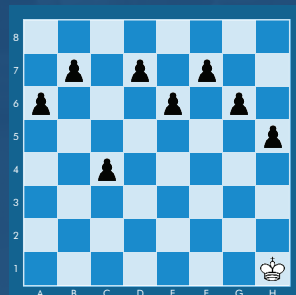


Figure 4.2

Capture the Pawns - King: Set up your chess board as shown to the right and see if you can use the King to capture all of the pawns in the least number of moves possible.

BONUS: Great job! For an extra challenge, repeat the previous exercise but this time make sure that your King never steps into danger. Can you find a way to accomplish this in just 18 moves? *Note: This requires an understanding of topic 9.*



TOPIC 5

THE ROOK

The **Rook** (sometimes incorrectly called a castle) moves up, down, left, or right, **1 - 7 squares** in any direction until the Rook reaches an obstruction or captures a piece (the Rook cannot jump over pieces and can only capture one piece per turn) [Ref: Figures 5.1 & 5.2]. The white Rooks begin the game in the corners, **a1** and **h1**. The black Rooks begin in the corners, **a8** and **h8**. The Rook has a piece value of **5 points**.

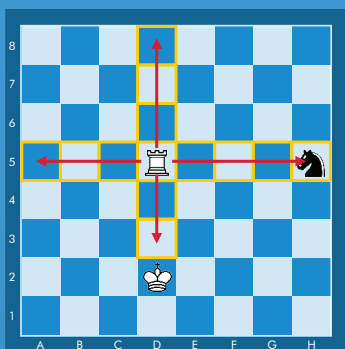


Figure 5.1

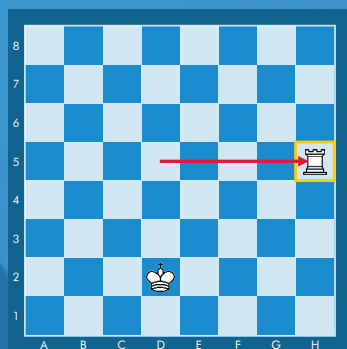
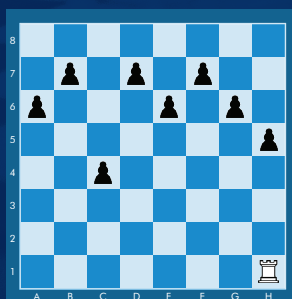


Figure 5.2

Fun Activity

Capture the Pawns - Rook: Set up your chess board as shown to the right and see if you can use the Rook to capture all of the pawns in the least number of moves possible.

BONUS: Now that you've figured out how to capture all of the pawns, try again, but this time make sure that the Rook never moves into danger. Can you find a way to accomplish this in just 12 moves? *Note: This requires an understanding of topic 9.*



THE BISHOP

The **Bishop** only moves **diagonally**. The Bishop may move 1-7 squares in any diagonal direction [Ref: Figure 6.1]. The Bishop **cannot** jump over pieces and can only capture one piece per turn [Ref: Figure 6.2]. Because the Bishop moves diagonally, it may never move to a different color other than the one it starts on. Each player has a light-squared Bishop and a dark-squared Bishop. The white Bishops begin on **c1** and **f1**. The black Bishops begin on **c8** and **f8**. The Bishop has a piece value of **3 points**.

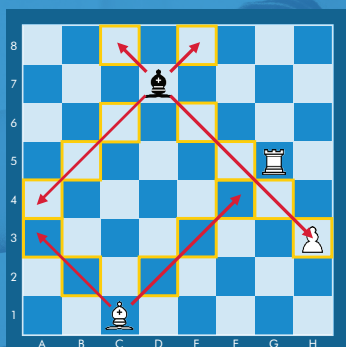


Figure 6.1

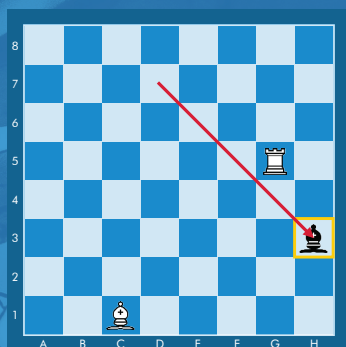
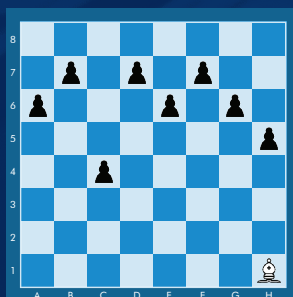


Figure 6.2

Capture the Pawns - Bishop: Set up your chess board as shown to the right and see if you can use the Bishop to capture all of the pawns in the least number of moves possible.

BONUS: Good job! For an extra challenge, repeat the previous exercise but this time make sure that your Bishop never steps into danger. Can you find a way to accomplish this in just 11 moves? *Note: This requires an understanding of topic 9.*



TOPIC 7

THE QUEEN

The **Queen** is the **most powerful** piece in the game of chess. The Queen can move 1-7 squares **in any direction**, up, down, left, right, or diagonal, until the Queen reaches an obstruction or captures a piece; however, the Queen cannot jump over pieces and can only capture one piece per turn [Ref: Figure 7.1 & 7.2]. The white Queen begins the game on **d1** and the black Queen on **d8**. The Queen has a piece value of **9 points**.

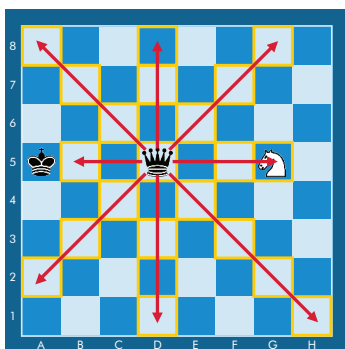


Figure 7.1

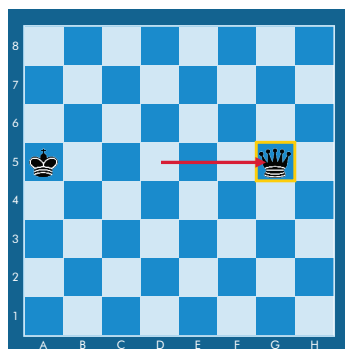
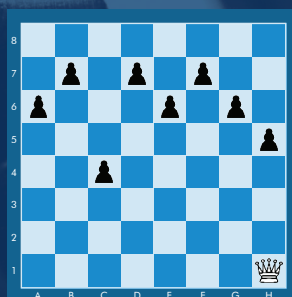


Figure 7.2

Fun Activity

Capture the Pawns - Queen: Set up your chess board as shown to the right and see if you can use the Queen to capture all of the pawns in the least number of moves possible.

BONUS: Fantastic! For an extra challenge, repeat the previous exercise but this time make sure that your Queen never steps into danger. Can you find a way to accomplish this in just 8 moves? *Note: This requires an understanding of topic 9.*



THE KNIGHT

The **Knight** moves in a direction described as an “L”. The Knight, from a starting square, moves **2 squares, up, down, left, or right**, and then **one square at a right angle**, forming an “L” [Ref: Figure 8.1 & 8.2]. The Knight is the **only piece** that may jump over other pieces but only captures the piece of the square that he lands on (not the pieces he jumps over). The white Knights begin the game on **b1** and **g1**. The black Knights begin on **b8** and **g8**. The Knight has a piece value of **3 points** (equal to the Bishop). *Note: Every move the Knight makes always changes the color of the square that it stands on.*

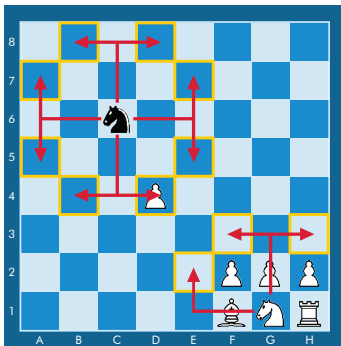


Figure 8.1

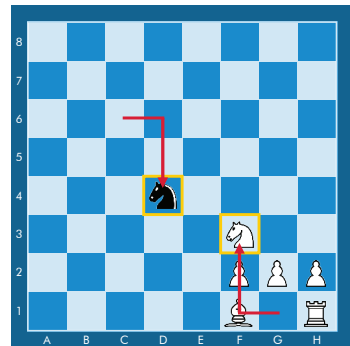
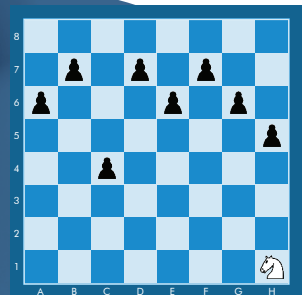


Figure 8.2

Capture the Pawns - Knight: Set up your chess board as shown to the right and see if you can use the Knight to capture all of the pawns in the least number of moves possible.

BONUS: Wonderful! For an extra challenge, repeat the previous exercise, but this time make sure that your Knight never steps into danger. Can you find a way to accomplish this in just 18 moves? *Note: This requires an understanding of topic 9.*



TOPIC 9

THE PAWNS

The **Pawn** moves directly forward [Ref: Figure 9.1], never backward or to the side. Pawns move exactly **one** square forward; though each Pawn may advance two squares forward **the first time it is moved**. Pawns capture a piece that is one square diagonally forward [Ref: Figure 9.2]. Though Pawns normally cannot move diagonally, this is the only way they capture. Pawns are the only piece that **capture differently than they move**. The white Pawns begin on the 2nd rank and the black Pawns begin on the 7th rank. The Pawn has a piece value of **1 point**.

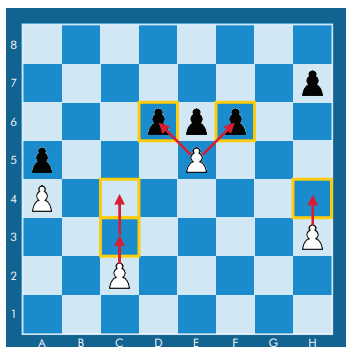


Figure 9.1

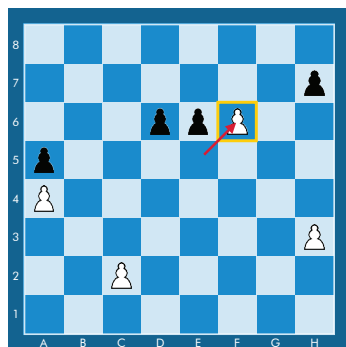
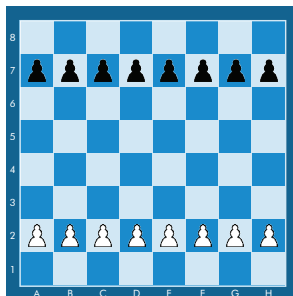


Figure 9.2

Fun Activity

Pawn Game: Set up the chess board like the diagram to the right. With a partner, play a game of chess using only Pawns on the board. The first person to get one of their Pawns to the other side of the board is the winner!



PAWN PROMOTION

Pawns are the only piece in chess that may promote. **Promotion** occurs when the Pawn reaches the **opposite** side of the board (1st rank for black, 8th rank for white). In the same turn, the Pawn is removed from the board and is **replaced** with an extra piece of the promoting player's choice [Ref: Figure 10.1 & 10.2], (**Queen, Rook, Bishop, or Knight**) even if these pieces are already on the board. This concludes the player's turn.

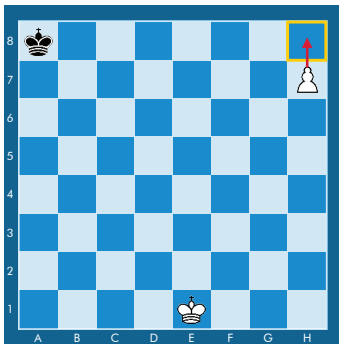


Figure 10.1

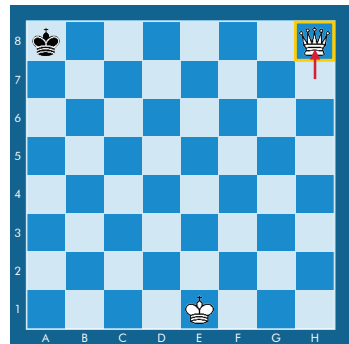
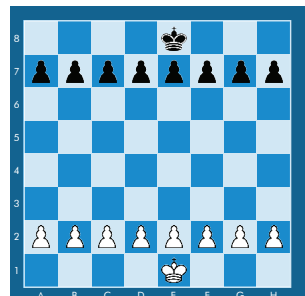


Figure 10.2

Pawn Game - Part 2: Set up the chess board like the diagram to the right. With a partner, play a game of chess with only Pawns and kings on the board. The goal of this game is to get one of your Pawns to the other side of the board and promote it! The winner is the first person to promote a Pawn and capture all of their opponent's Pawns.



TOPIC 11

CHECKMATE

Checkmate immediately ends the game (the King is never removed from the board) and players shake hands to agree. Checkmate is the goal of the game of chess. Checkmate is when one player puts the opponent's King in danger (called "check") and the opponent can do nothing with their King or any other pieces to stop the King from being in danger [Ref: Figure 11.1 & 11.2] (**run away** with the King, **capture** the checking piece, or use another piece to **block**.) [Ref: Figure 11.3]

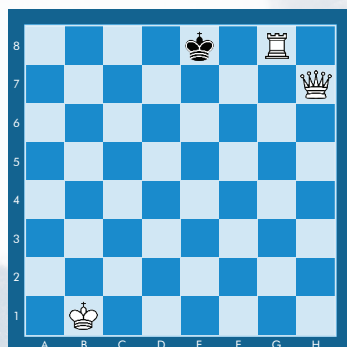


Figure 11.1

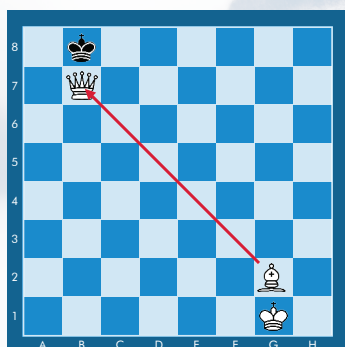


Figure 11.2

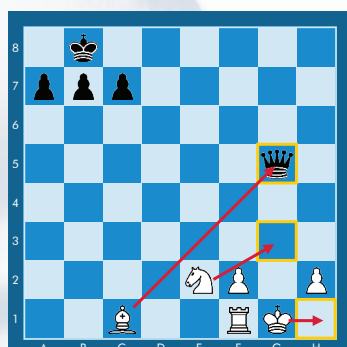


Figure 11.3

Fun Activity

Make-a-Mate: Using the pieces designated as "You have," set the pieces on the board so that the "Defending" King is in Checkmate.

	1	2	3	4
You Have	 	 	 	
Defender			 (e8)	  

CASTLING

Castling is a special move to make the **King safer**. In one turn, the King moves **two squares** towards one Rook and that Rook **jumps** over the King, landing next to the King. [Ref: Figure 12.1 & 12.2]

Rules for Castling:

1. The King cannot castle if either the King or the Rook involved have already moved in that game.
2. There can be no pieces between the King and the Rook.
3. The King cannot castle while in check. [Ref: Figure 12.3]
4. The King cannot castle into or through check. [Ref: Figure 12.4]
5. The King can never “un-castle”.

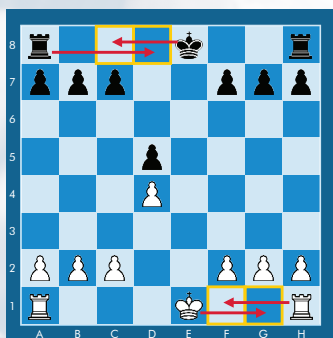


Figure 12.1

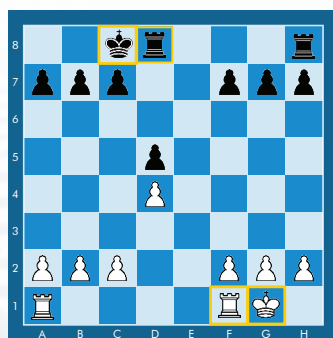


Figure 12.2

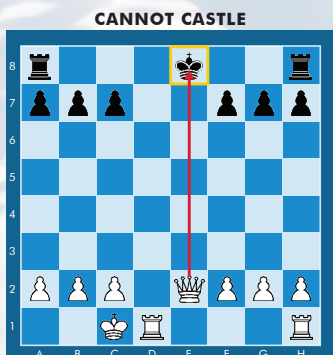


Figure 12.3

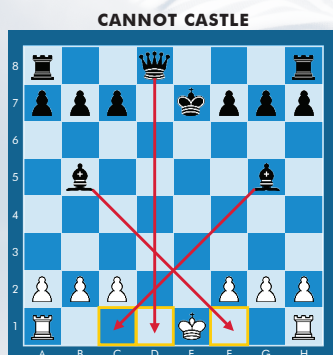


Figure 12.4

TOPIC 13

EN PASSANT

En Passant is a special Pawn move. If a Pawn steps forward **two squares**, landing adjacent to an opponent's Pawn, the opponent's Pawn may capture as though it moved only one square. The En Passant capture may only take place after a Pawn moves two squares and only on the move immediately following. [Ref: Figures 13.1 & 13.2]

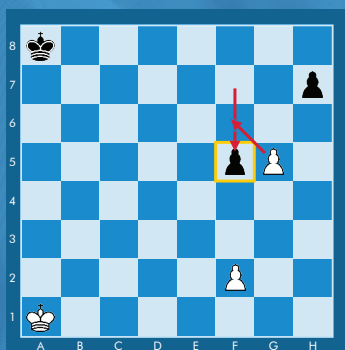


Figure 13.1

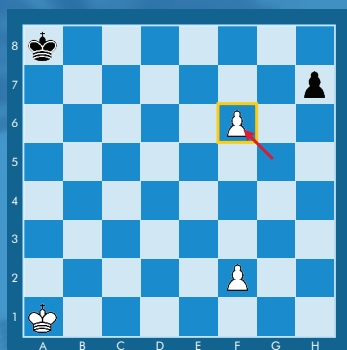
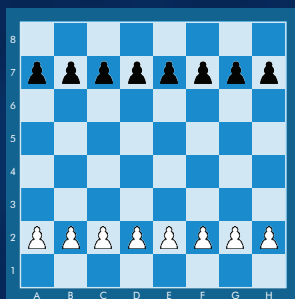


Figure 13.2

Fun Activity

En Passant Challenge: Set up the chess board like the diagram to the right. With a partner, play a game of chess using only Pawns on the board. This is a cooperative game where the goal is to work with your partner to see how many En Passant captures you can do in one game.



DRAWS

A Draw is when neither player wins or loses. There are several types of draws in chess. Some common ways that a draw can occur are:

STALEMATE

Stalemate occurs when a player has no possible legal moves on their turn and their King is not in check [Ref: Figure 14.1 & 14.2].

INSUFFICIENT MATERIAL

Insufficient material occurs when neither player has adequate pieces left on the board to achieve a checkmate [Ref: Figure 14.3 & 14.4].

OFFERED DRAW

A draw can be achieved by one player offering a draw to his opponent. His opponent can then choose to either accept or decline the draw.

THREEFOLD REPETITION

A draw is achieved through Threefold Repetition when the same position occurs three times in a single game. The repeated position does not need to occur in succession.

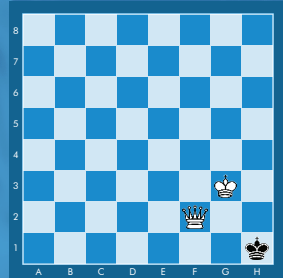


Figure 14.1

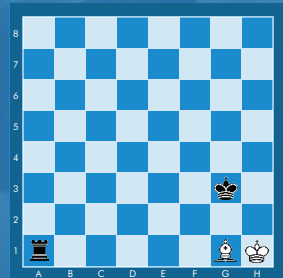


Figure 14.2

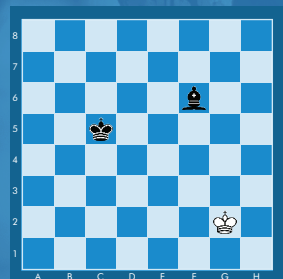


Figure 14.3

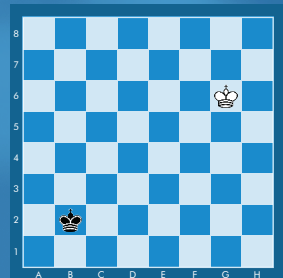


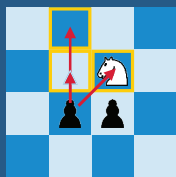
Figure 14.4

CHESS PIECE QUICK GUIDE

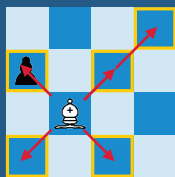
PIECE	INITIAL	VALUE	ICON
Pawn	P	1 Point	 
Knight	N	3 Points	 
Bishop	B	3 Points	 
Rook	R	5 Points	 
Queen	Q	9 Points	 
King	K	The Game	 

PIECE MOVEMENT

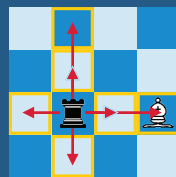
PAWN



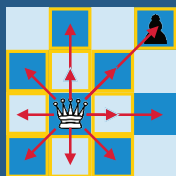
BISHOP



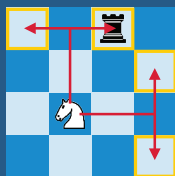
ROOK



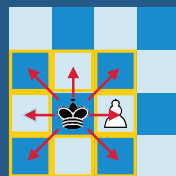
QUEEN



KNIGHT



KING





Chess4Life™

National Master and chess champion Elliott Neff founded Chess4Life in 2005 with a mission to develop children's life skills through the fun game of chess. Chess4Life supports from beginner through championship levels, building critical thinking skills, problem solving, and EQ, not just IQ. Now with a goal of impacting 1 million students per week, Chess4Life provides both direct-to-student lessons and train-the-trainer tools empowering even non-chess playing teachers to bring these benefits of chess to a diverse audience.

Visit **chess4life.com** for the best live training for young players.

SCORE SHEET

WHITE _____ BLACK _____

DATE _____ RESULT _____

NR.	WHITE	BLACK
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		
7		
8		
9		
10		
11		
12		
13		
14		
15		
16		
17		
18		
19		
20		
21		
22		
23		
24		
25		
26		
27		
28		
29		
30		
31		
32		
33		
34		
35		
36		
37		
38		
39		
40		

WHITE _____ BLACK _____

DATE _____ RESULT _____

NR.	WHITE	BLACK
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		
7		
8		
9		
10		
11		
12		
13		
14		
15		
16		
17		
18		
19		
20		
21		
22		
23		
24		
25		
26		
27		
28		
29		
30		
31		
32		
33		
34		
35		
36		
37		
38		
39		
40		

SCORE SHEET

WHITE _____ BLACK _____

DATE _____ RESULT _____

NR.	WHITE	BLACK
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		
7		
8		
9		
10		
11		
12		
13		
14		
15		
16		
17		
18		
19		
20		
21		
22		
23		
24		
25		
26		
27		
28		
29		
30		
31		
32		
33		
34		
35		
36		
37		
38		
39		
40		

WHITE _____ BLACK _____

DATE _____ RESULT _____

NR.	WHITE	BLACK
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		
7		
8		
9		
10		
11		
12		
13		
14		
15		
16		
17		
18		
19		
20		
21		
22		
23		
24		
25		
26		
27		
28		
29		
30		
31		
32		
33		
34		
35		
36		
37		
38		
39		
40		



CHESS IN EVERY HOME

ENJOY "THE RULES OF CHESS"? SHARE IT WITH A FRIEND!

For more resources like this one, visit www.chess4life.com